



GFWC COLORADO

A proud member of the
General Federation of Women's Clubs

GFWC and GFWC Colorado membership

As a member of your local club, you are also a member of the GFWC Colorado Federation of Women's Clubs and the General Federation of Women's Clubs or GFWC.

General Federation of Women's Clubs



Headquarters – Washington, DC
#UnityInDiversity
#LivingTheVolunteerSpirit

GFWC Headquarters

Our International headquarters administrative offices are located at 1734 N Street NW, Washington, DC 20036

This is the home of the GFWC International President during her two-year term.

Our taglines and motto are: Unity in Diversity and Living the Volunteer Spirit.

GFWC Women's History & Resource Center



GFWC Women's History and Resource Center

The GFWC Women's History and Resource Center is also located in Washington, DC. The WHRC collects, preserves, interprets, and promotes the history of the GFWC and women volunteers. The WHRC documents the social and political contributions of GFWC clubwomen from 1890 to the present through the GFWC archives, related special collections, and publications.

GFWC was founded in 1890 by Jane Cunningham Croly



**“Is it possible that women may have a life of their own,
may learn to know and honor each other,
may find solace in companionship,
and lose sight of small troubles in large aims?”**

History of GFWC

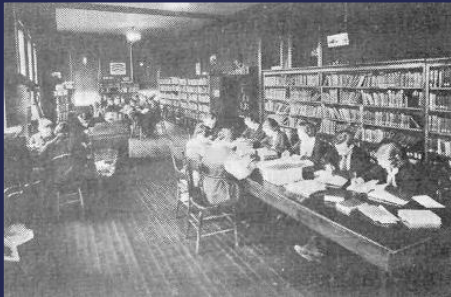
GFWC has a rich history since its founding in 1890.

In 1868, Jennie June Croly, an accomplished New York newspaperwoman, was denied admittance to a Banquet honoring Charles Dickens at the all-male New York Press Club, simply because she was a woman. Outraged, she was determined to organize a club for women. The General Federation was founded in 1890, with the motto, “Unity in Diversity.”

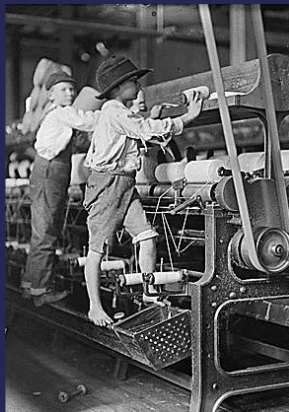
This group of women has grown into one of the largest organizations of volunteer women in the world.

GFWC has nearly 80,000 members in affiliated clubs in every state, the District of Columbia, and [more than a dozen countries](#).

GFWC



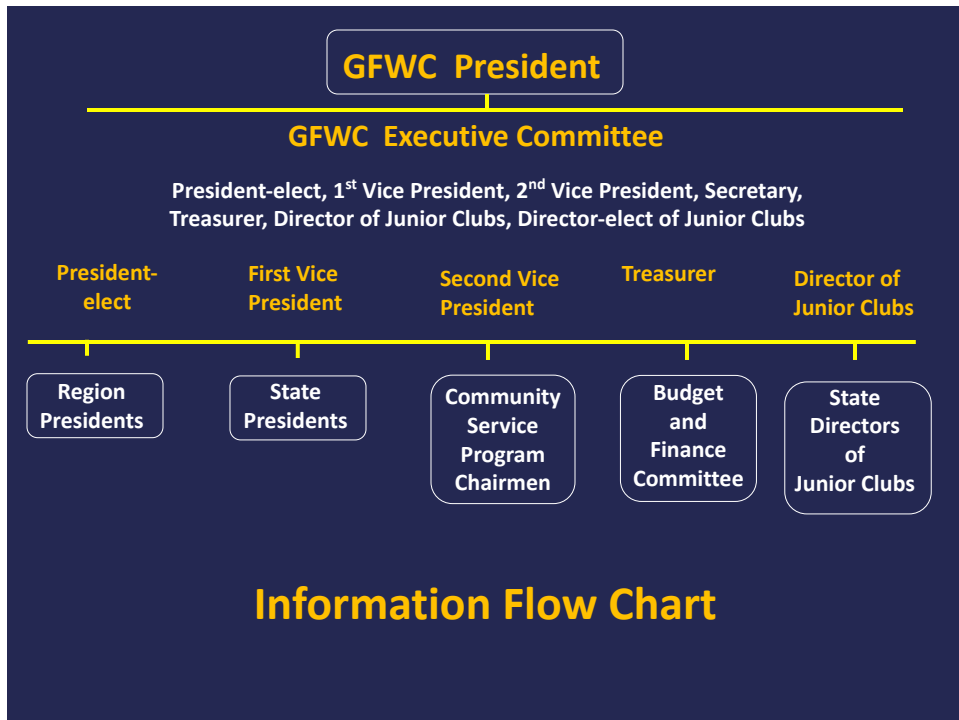
**Established 75% of
the Nation's Libraries**



**Passage of the
Child Labor Laws**

GFWC – Libraries, Food and Drug Act and Child Labor Laws

GFWC was instrumental in establishing most of the nation's libraries and helped to pass the Pure Food and Drug Act and the first child labor laws.



Flow Chart of Information

This chart shows how information passes from GFWC to the regions and state federations.

GFWC By the Numbers

- 63,000 members,
- 2600 clubs across the globe
- 136+ years in existence

2024 Statistics:

- 106,509 Projects Completed
- 5.3 million volunteer hours
- 14.3 million dollars donated
- 10 million dollars in-kind donations

**GFWC
2026-2028
Executive
Committee**



Wendy Carriker
President



Jolie Frankfurth
President-elect



Mary Beth Williams
1st Vice President



Dr. Susan Gettys
2nd Vice President



Juliet Casper
Secretary



Jennifer Nowak
Treasurer



Trina Behbahani
Director of Junior Clubs

GFWC International officers are elected by voting members at the GFWC annual convention in the even-numbered years. The term of office is two years.

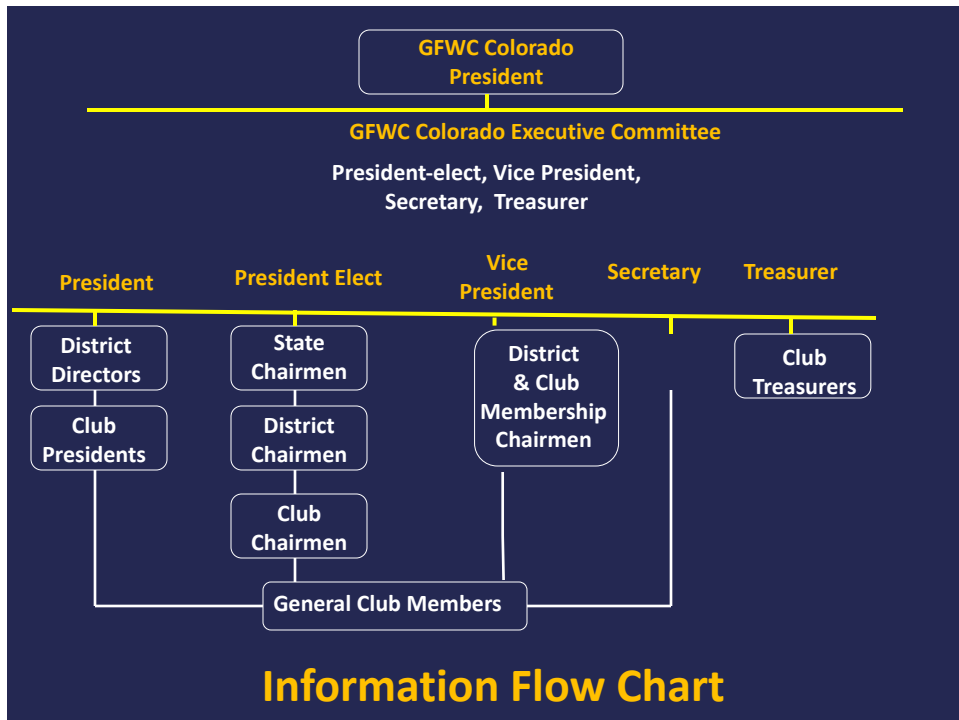
GFWC COLORADO



Organized in 1895
129 years of volunteer service

GFWC Colorado was organized in 1895. We do not have a house for keeping our archives. They are archived at the Colorado University repository. Individual clubs may store their information at a local source, such as the local library.

The president of GFWC CO and the executive committee members oversee the operation of our state Federation.



Flow Chart of Information

This chart shows how information passes from the GFWC Colorado state president and executive committee members to the club officers and the general membership.

**2026-2028
Executive
Committee**




Helen Lester
GFWC COLORADO
PRESIDENT






Sue O'Dell
Pres.-Elect

Lois Florkey
Vice-President

Ginny Bond
Secretary

Lisa Graham
Treasurer

Your text here

GFWC Colorado officers are elected by voting members at the annual convention in the even-numbered years. The term of office is two years.

GFWC Colorado State Approved Projects



- Mesa Verde National Park
- Rocky Mountain National Park

Colorado Federation club women led the way in preserving Mesa Verde and its establishment as a National Park in 1901. Virginia McClurg, a club woman, visited Mesa Verde in 1886 and recognized the need to preserve the artifacts and site. She enlisted the support of the GFWC Colorado Federation. Lucy Peabody, A Denver club woman, also played a significant part in establishing the Park.

Rocky Mountain National Park was established on January 26, 1915 by President Woodrow Wilson. Mary Belle King Sherman, a CFWC member and GFWC Conservation chairman (1914-1920) was actively involved in the establishment of Rocky Mountain National Park. She was nicknamed the “National Park Lady” for her guidance in the formation of six national parks.

GFWC Colorado Projects

- President's Special Project
- CFWC 1895 Society
- Minnie L. Harding Educational Loan Fund (MLHELF)

These projects are exclusive to GFWC Colorado and supported by club members.

The President's Special Project is the project named by the current president and club members will do projects and provide support. This project is funded through the cancelled stamps program.

The CFWC 1895 Society: Income to this fund comes from memorial gifts and contributions of any amount. Interest from the fund may be used for CFWC State Officers travel expenses. The CFWC 1895 Society is named for the year CFWC joined GFWC.

Minnie L. Harding Educational Loan Fund is unique to GFWC Colorado. Female residents of Colorado who are high school graduates or have a GED certificate pursuing a degree in professional field or are attending an accredited vocational school may apply to this program. MLHELF has its own set of bylaws.

GFWC Colorado

2 Districts

Peaks District

Chalets, GFWC NOCO Larks, Mountain Pine Woman's Club, Southwest Region Woman's Club and Woman's Club of Colorado Springs

Plains District

Fowler Progress, Granada Women's Civic, MSA Stratton, and Woman's Citizenship Club

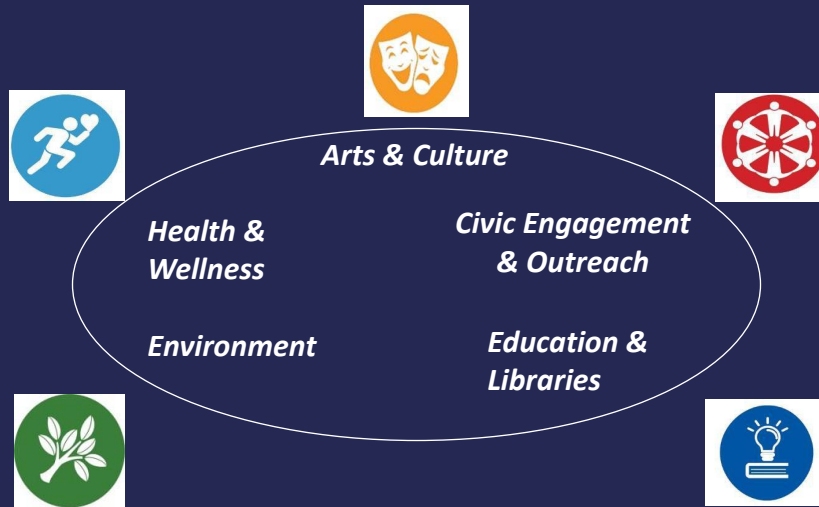
GFWC Colorado club membership.

GFWC COLORADO IS A MEMBER OF WESTERN STATES REGION

Alaska, California, Hawaii, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, Oregon, Utah,
Washington and Wyoming

GFWC Colorado is part of this region along with Alaska, California, Hawaii, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, Oregon, Utah, Washington and Wyoming.

GFWC Colorado Community Service Programs



GFWC Colorado by the numbers (2025)

- **9 clubs**
- **233 members**
- **Over 10,000 (countless) hours volunteer service**
- **Nearly \$120,000 in community grants, scholarships, monetary & in-kind donations**
- **376 community service projects completed**

Membership Classifications

General Membership

Junior Membership

Juniorette Membership

Ages 12- 18



Member Benefits

The three most common benefits in belonging to a federated club are: community service, personal growth and development, and fellowship and friendships.

As a civic organization, we are able to pinpoint our community needs and strive to meet those needs.

At our club meetings, we grow by working together toward common goals. Our members are taught leadership skills and techniques that help them in all aspects of their lives.

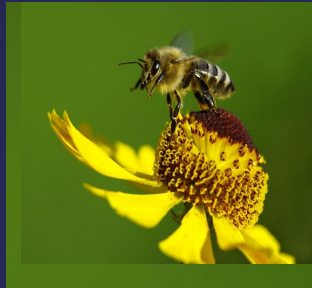
Camaraderie is an important benefit of belonging to a federated club. We share and make friends as we make a difference in our communities.

GFWC Colorado 2024-2026

President's Special Project

GFWC Colorado's State President, Helen Lester, has chosen the theme: Bee the Change You Want to See in the World.

This theme gives each club the opportunity to focus on the needs of your community. Helen would also like to see support for safe pollination opportunities for bees and/or support to veterans and our military. Helen is confident everyone will be rolling up their sleeves and getting "buzzed" with ideas and excitement.

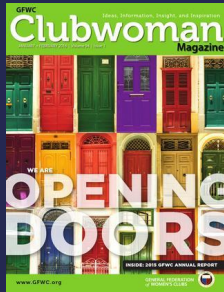


Membership Responsibilities

- ✓ *Attend regular meetings*
- ✓ *Participate in community service and fund raising events*
- ✓ *Pay club dues*
- ✓ *Help membership grow*

Sharing our message

GFWC



- Clubwoman magazine
- News & Notes
- Webinars

GFWC Colorado

- CFWC Clubwoman Newsletter
- President Communications

GFWC Colorado
Facebook Page

GFWC.org

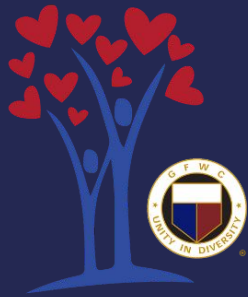
Sharing our message

The GFWC Clubwoman magazine is published quarterly by GFWC headquarters and provides a link to all clubwomen around the world. It is available by subscription only. GFWC News & Notes is a monthly electronic newsletter published by GFWC. It is available by email and on the website.

GFWC Colorado Clubwoman Newsletter is published quarterly and is sent to all club members.

GFWC Colorado

- Thank you for living the volunteer spirit!!



GFWC Southwest Region Woman's Club

GFWC/SRWC

- Established April 24, 1998
- Club Color: Yellow
- Club Flower: Tulip
- Club Purpose: To promote intellectual, educational, social, and civic improvements, and to participate in the programs of the GFWC & CFWC. We shall conduct ourselves as a non-profit, non-partisan, and non-sectarian organization

GFWC/SRWC

- Monthly meetings September-May at St Paul's Church- 9200 W 10th Ave in Lakewood
- We gather at 6:30 pm for some refreshments and program begins at 7 pm
- Yearly dues \$40- pay in September
- Programs, Service Projects, and Fundraising are determined by Members!
- 45 members (as of Dec 2025)

GFWC/SRWC

- Officers: 2026-2028
 - President: Laurie Cole
 - Secretary: Kelley Walter
 - Treasurer: Dianne DeBerard

GFWC/SRWC

- We are known for:
 - Tampon Party
 - Adopt-A-Family at Christmas
 - Charity Walks
 - Excellent Speakers
 - Support for Shot@Life- UNFoundation
 - Support of The Action Center in Lakewood
 - 2025- 70 projects/programs; 2376 volunteer hours; \$13,700 direct donations to local and international charities; \$17,000 in-kind donations!

GFWC/SRWC

- New members always welcome
- Attend club meetings and functions as you are able
- Volunteer to help plan a meeting; bring food for meetings; participate in service projects
- Attend District, State, Regional, and International meetings as desired
- Visit our GFWC historic headquarters in Washington DC

GFWC/ SRWC

- Fun, Food, Fellowship!!!
- Help new members get connected!
- Stay connected: Newsletter, Website, Facebook page, EVITE's, emails
- Attend via Zoom/Hybrid meetings as health concerns/distance/weather dictate.
- Ask Questions
- Welcome to GFWC/Southwest Region Woman's Club!